

英検準1級 リーディング問題

2023年度 第1回

氏名 _____ 実施日 _____



解答方法 各問について、最も適切なものを1つ選び、問題冊子の選択肢に○を付けてください。

正解は最終ページにあります。すべて解いてから確認してください。

ReadPassで復習

大問1 語彙・文法 Q1-Q4

次の(1)から(25)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

(1) At first, Mick was (1) by the idea of going to live abroad by himself. Once he did it, however, it was less difficult than he had feared.

- 1 pacified 2 restored 3 daunted 4 tackled

(2) Students are advised to pace their studying throughout the semester instead of (2) right before their exams.

- 1 cramming 2 detaining 3 swelling 4 embracing

(3) The two candidates' tempers (3) during the presidential debate. They angrily attacked each other's positions on issues throughout the night.

- 1 flared 2 digested 3 professed 4 tumbled

(4) Many banks required government (4) to stay in business after the stock market crash. The help mostly came in the form of large loans.

- 1 intervention 2 appreciation 3 accumulation 4 starvation

大問1 語彙・文法 Q5-Q11

次の(1)から(25)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

- (5) Police must follow strict (5) at a crime scene to make sure the evidence is not damaged or altered in any way.
1 tributes 2 protocols 3 reservoirs 4 portions
- (6) The umpire (6) the two players for fighting. They were not allowed to play in the rest of the game.
1 slaughtered 2 administered 3 ejected 4 conceived
- (7) Cats are known to be protective of their (7). They often attack other animals that they think could be a threat to their kittens.
1 prey 2 offspring 3 rituals 4 remains
- (8) Fans of Greenville United were disappointed when the team's poor performance throughout the season led to its (8) from the A-League to the B-League.
1 demotion 2 craving 3 aggravation 4 hassle
- (9) Bibi loves hiking and playing sports, so she needs clothes that do not wear out too quickly. When she goes shopping, she generally buys clothing that is (9).
1 swift 2 aloof 3 shallow 4 durable
- (10) Consumers should not (10) any personal information to callers claiming to be from the bank, as such calls are sometimes from criminals.
1 sway 2 detest 3 contemplate 4 disclose
- (11) Because the tennis champion is unfriendly to other players and claims he is the greatest player who has ever lived, he is often criticized for his (11).
1 commodity 2 arrogance 3 neutrality 4 specimen

大問1 語彙・文法 Q12-Q18

次の(1)から(25)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

- (12) Many readers found the author's novels (12). He was known for writing long, confusing sentences that had no clear meaning.
- 1 genuine 2 impending 3 subdued 4 incomprehensible
- (13) "Class, I want you all to listen very (13)," the teacher said. "Much of what I will say is not in the textbook but will be on the test."
- 1 attentively 2 consecutively 3 wearily 4 eloquently
- (14) The school is known for being at the (14) of education. Its teachers use the newest teaching methods and the latest technology in the classroom.
- 1 forefront 2 lapse 3 doctrine 4 myth
- (15) The mayor used (15) language in his speech because he thought it was extremely important that the citizens support his plan for public transportation.
- 1 forceful 2 merciful 3 futile 4 tranquil
- (16) When the pop singer died, she left her favorite charity a (16) of over \$10 million. "We are so grateful for her generosity," said a charity spokesperson.
- 1 rhyme 2 justice 3 legacy 4 majority
- (17) As they approached the top of the mountain, some of the hikers began to feel sick because of the low oxygen levels at the high (17).
- 1 apparatus 2 equation 3 altitude 4 mileage
- (18) Ted lives on a (18) income. He makes just enough to afford a small apartment, pay his bills, and occasionally go out for dinner.
- 1 blissful 2 modest 3 showy 4 sturdy

大問1 語彙・文法 Q19-Q25

次の(1)から(25)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

- (19) The carpenter was careful to choose a (19) piece of wood for the table. There would be problems if it did not have the same thickness throughout.
1 reckless 2 gaping 3 dreary 4 uniform
- (20) Although Pieter was a private, quiet man who rarely showed his (20) for his children, they knew that he truly loved them.
1 affection 2 circulation 3 oppression 4 coalition
- (21) Anton heard a strange (21) coming from his speakers, so he checked to make sure all the cables were properly connected.
1 buzz 2 peck 3 thorn 4 core
- (22) Late last night, a man was caught trying to (22) a convenience store. The police forced him to drop his weapon and arrested him.
1 shrug off 2 sit out 3 run against 4 hold up
- (23) Jill had always loved France, so when there was a chance to work in her company's Paris office, she (23) it. In fact, she was the first to apply.
1 plowed through 2 pulled on 3 threw off 4 jumped at
- (24) **A:** How's the class you signed up for going to (24) with your work schedule?
B: It's online, and I can study at my own pace. I can read the material when I get home from work, so it should be fine.
1 get over 2 fit in 3 hold onto 4 take after
- (25) Before moving to her new section, Betty will (25) all of her current projects to the person who will be doing her job from now on.
1 beef up 2 bank on 3 hand over 4 slip by

大問2A 長文の語句空所補充 Q26-Q28

次の英文A, Bを読み, その文意にそって(26)から(31)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを選びなさい。

Beyond Small Talk

Research indicates that the relationships people have can influence their well-being. Positive relationships not only lead to increased happiness but also have a beneficial effect on physical health. So far, most studies have focused on relationships with people we are close to, such as family members or friends. This makes sense, as when we have a problem or want to share our thoughts and opinions, we are most likely to talk to such people. (26), some recent studies have explored how we interact with strangers, and the results were rather surprising.

In one study, subjects were paired up with someone they had never met before, and each pair was asked to come up with a light discussion topic, such as the weather, and a more substantial one, such as their personal goals. At the beginning of the study, most subjects thought they would enjoy casual conversations more. After each conversation, the subjects were asked to rate it based on enjoyment and feeling of connection with their partners. The results showed that the (27). That is, most subjects reported having a more positive experience overall after discussing serious topics.

The study's results suggest that people would benefit from interacting on a deeper level with strangers. In fact, the subjects in the study generally expressed a desire to have meaningful conversations with people they did not know more often in their lives. However, they also thought that (28). The researchers believe that this assumption is incorrect, and that, for the most part, strangers are also interested in going beyond casual conversation.

(26)

- 1 In exchange 2 For instance 3 In contrast 4 In short

(27)

- 1 topics had made the subjects nervous 2 subjects' ratings did not always match 3 topic choices had been too varied 4 subjects' expectations had been wrong

(28)

- 1 communicating clearly would be difficult 2 other people did not share this desire 3 their family members would not approve 4 their privacy should come first

大問2B 長文の語句空所補充 Q29-Q31

次の英文A, Bを読み, その文意にそって(26)から(31)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを選びなさい。

The Thing

After spending nearly a decade on a museum shelf in Chile, a mysterious fossil known as "The Thing" has finally been identified. Researchers now believe it is a 66-million-year-old soft-shelled egg and that it probably contained a mosasaur, a large aquatic reptile that existed around the same time as dinosaurs. Previous fossil evidence had suggested that mosasaurs (29). The researchers' findings challenge this idea, however, and the researchers say the fossil's size and the fact that it was discovered in an area where mosasaur fossils have been found support their conclusion.

Although the researchers are excited to have identified The Thing, it has opened a new debate. One theory suggests mosasaurs would have laid their eggs in open water, with the young hatching almost immediately. (30), some scientists believe the mosasaurs would have laid their eggs on the beach and buried them, much like some modern reptiles do. Further research, it is hoped, will reveal which of these is correct.

Another group of researchers from the United States has shed additional light on the eggs of prehistoric creatures after taking a closer look at previously discovered fossils of baby dinosaurs. It was believed that dinosaurs produced hard-shelled eggs, but the fossils on which this assumption was based represent a limited number of dinosaur species. Through their analysis, the US researchers discovered evidence that suggests the eggs of early dinosaurs were, in fact, soft-shelled. If true, this could explain why (31). Since softer materials break down easily, they are much less likely to be preserved in the fossil record.

(29)

- | | | | | | | | |
|---|---------------------------------|---|-------------------------|---|------------------|---|-------------------------------------|
| 1 | were likely hunted by dinosaurs | 2 | relied on eggs for food | 3 | did not lay eggs | 4 | may not have existed with dinosaurs |
|---|---------------------------------|---|-------------------------|---|------------------|---|-------------------------------------|

(30)

- | | | | | | | | |
|---|----------|---|-------------------|---|-------------|---|-------------|
| 1 | Likewise | 2 | On the other hand | 3 | As a result | 4 | For example |
|---|----------|---|-------------------|---|-------------|---|-------------|

(31)

- | | | | | | | | |
|---|-----------------------------------|---|-------------------------------------|---|--|---|---------------------------------------|
| 1 | few dinosaur eggs have been found | 2 | there are not more dinosaur species | 3 | some dinosaurs were unable to produce eggs | 4 | dinosaur babies often did not survive |
|---|-----------------------------------|---|-------------------------------------|---|--|---|---------------------------------------|

大問3A 長文

本文を読み、次ページのQ32-Q34に答えなさい。

The Chicken of Tomorrow

Before the 1940s, most chickens in the United States were raised on family farms, and the main emphasis was on egg production rather than obtaining meat. Poverty and food shortages were common at that time, so people wanted to maintain a regular source of protein without sacrificing their chickens. Additionally, there were a tremendous variety of chickens being raised, as farmers generally chose a breed based on how well it was adapted to the local conditions - whether it was suited to a dry or a humid climate, for example.

After World War II, however, the growing availability of meat such as pork and beef meant eggs could not compete as a source of protein. The US Department of Agriculture therefore set up an event called the Chicken of Tomorrow contest to find a type of chicken that could be raised economically and produced more meat. The overall winner, which was a combination of different breeds, grew faster and larger than other types, and it could adapt to various climates. Inspired by the contest, breeding companies began creating complicated mixtures of chicken varieties to guarantee a consistent supply of birds with these same desirable features. Since producing such genetic combinations was difficult, most farmers had no choice but to purchase young chickens from those companies rather than breeding them by themselves - a development that completely changed the industry.

The contest helped popularize the consumption of chicken meat, but this trend also had a dark side. It became more economical to raise massive numbers of chickens in large facilities where they were confined in small cages. Not only did this force numerous small farms out of business, but it also created conditions for the birds that, according to animal rights activists, caused the chickens stress and led to higher levels of sickness. While the contest made chicken a regular food item, some people questioned whether it was worth it.

大問3A 長文設問 Q32-Q34

前ページの本文を読み、最も適切なものを1つ選びなさい。

- (32) What is one thing that we learn about the US chicken industry before the 1940s?
- 1 The type of chicken raised on each farm usually depended on the climate in the area where the farm was located.
 - 2 Each farm would raise more than one type of chicken in case there was a sudden change in environmental conditions.
 - 3 Chickens were generally only eaten by very poor people or at times when there were food shortages.
 - 4 Because there were so many chicken farms across the country, many of the eggs produced ended up being wasted.
- (33) The US Department of Agriculture organized the Chicken of Tomorrow contest because
- 1 other types of meat, such as pork and beef, were becoming more expensive, so the American people wanted a cheaper alternative.
 - 2 most chicken farms were focused on egg production, which led to a need to create a chicken that was more suitable for producing meat.
 - 3 a large number of chicken farms in America went out of business, which severely decreased the availability of chicken meat.
 - 4 the American people were tired of eating the same type of eggs for so long, so producers wanted a different type of chicken.
- (34) What is one way that the contest affected the chicken industry?
- 1 Farmers learned that it was relatively easy to combine several types of chickens, which encouraged them to breed new varieties.
 - 2 Although the number of small chicken farms increased across America, many of these were often poorly run and had cheap facilities.
 - 3 It started a move toward keeping chickens in conditions that increased the birds' suffering and made them less healthy.
 - 4 Farmers realized that improving their farming methods could help them to raise chickens that produced more and better-tasting meat.

大問3B 長文

本文を読み、次ページのQ35-Q37に答えなさい。

Discipline in American Schools

For decades, methods of discipline used in American schools have been based on the theories of psychologist B. F. Skinner, who believed that systems of reward and punishment were the most effective methods of improving people's behavior. Commonly, students who break rules are given punishments, such as being prohibited from attending classes for a day or more or being made to stay in class after the school day ends. These are designed to teach the students to follow teachers' instructions and respect classmates. Recent psychological studies, however, have determined that as effective as punishment may be in bringing peace to the classroom temporarily, it can intensify the very behavior it is intended to correct when used continually over an extended period of time.

Many experts now believe that in order for children to learn to behave appropriately, it is essential that they develop self-control. When students are punished to make them obey the rules, they are being forced to adopt good behavior through external pressure. Self-control, on the other hand, comes from internal motivation, self-confidence, and the ability to be tolerant of others, and using punishment as a substitute for these things can actually delay or prevent their development. Similarly, the use of rewards such as stickers leads to students merely attempting to please the teacher rather than understanding the importance of gaining knowledge and social skills that will help them throughout their lives.

In recent years, an increasing amount of research has been backing up these ideas. A region of the brain known as the prefrontal cortex helps us to concentrate on tasks and is responsible for self-discipline and allowing us to consider the consequences of our actions. Research suggests that the prefrontal cortex may be less developed in students with behavioral problems. Fortunately, though, there is evidence that repeated experiences can alter the brain's structure, which suggests that it is also possible to influence the development of the prefrontal cortex. Child-behavior expert Ross Greene believes that when educators change their attitudes so that they actually listen to students' feelings about their bad behavior and encourage them to come up with solutions to the issues they face, this can have a physical effect on the prefrontal cortex. Greene has designed a highly successful program that has greatly reduced behavioral problems at many schools.

大問3B 長文設問 Q35-Q37

前ページの本文を読み、最も適切なものを1つ選びなさい。

- (35) What has psychological research shown about the use of punishment in schools?
- 1 It is only likely to be effective when it is used together with rewards in order to reduce its negative effects.
 - 2 Though it may succeed in producing better behavior in the short term, it can actually be harmful in the long term.
 - 3 There are various new types of punishment that are far more effective than physical punishment.
 - 4 Using some form of punishment is necessary for forcing students to obey teachers and respect their classmates.
-
- (36) According to the passage, what is one effect the use of rewards has on students?
- 1 It can teach them the advantages of hard work and make them better at focusing on their academic goals.
 - 2 It causes them to want material things and makes them less aware of the need to behave in ways that are pleasing to other people.
 - 3 It can prevent them from developing important skills that would be beneficial to them later in life.
 - 4 It helps them to realize the importance of deciding their own goals rather than just doing what their teachers tell them to do.
-
- (37) What does Ross Greene believe about children's brains?
- 1 Helping children solve their own problems can promote the development of the part of the brain that controls behavior.
 - 2 Since the brains of younger children function in a different way to those of older children, different methods of dealing with behavioral issues are necessary.
 - 3 The region of the brain known as the prefrontal cortex may be less important in controlling children's behavior than some scientists believe it is.
 - 4 Bad behavior does not only have a negative effect on children's academic performance but also permanently prevents the normal development of their brains.
-

大問3C 長文

本文を読み、次ページのQ38-Q41に答えなさい。

Robert the Bruce and the Declaration of Arbroath

In 1286, the sudden death of King Alexander III of Scotland resulted in a power struggle among various nobles that nearly brought the country to civil war. To settle the matter, England's King Edward I was asked to select a new ruler from among the rivals. Edward, who himself had ambitions to ultimately rule Scotland, agreed only on the condition that the new leader pledged loyalty to him. He chose a noble named John Balliol as the new king, but resentment soon grew as England repeatedly exerted its authority over Scotland's affairs. The turning point came when Edward attempted to force Scotland to provide military assistance in England's conflict with France. When Balliol allied his nation with France instead, Edward invaded Scotland, defeated Balliol, and took the throne.

This was the situation faced by the Scottish noble Robert the Bruce as he attempted to free Scotland from English rule. Robert, whose father had been one of Balliol's rivals for the throne, gained political dominance and led a rebellion that drove English forces from Scotland. Robert was crowned king of Scotland in 1306, and although he enjoyed tremendous support domestically, he had angered the Pope, the leader of the Roman Catholic Church. Not only had he ignored the church's requests that he make peace with England, but he had also taken the life of his closest rival to the throne in a place of worship before being crowned king.

Scotland's leadership knew that the country would remain internationally isolated and vulnerable without the church's recognition. International acceptance of Scotland's independence would be especially important if the country were to exist in the shadow of a mighty nation like England, which still failed to officially acknowledge Robert as Scotland's king despite having retreated. In 1320, Scotland's most powerful nobles therefore gathered to create a document known today as the Declaration of Arbroath. It proclaimed Scotland's independence and requested the Pope recognize Robert as the country's ruler. The response the nobles received later in the year, however, indicated that the declaration initially had not been effective. The Pope not only refused Scotland's request but also failed to confirm its self-proclaimed independence, although he did urge England to pursue a peaceful resolution in its dealings with the nation. A few years later, however, the declaration's influence contributed to the Pope recognizing Robert and his kingdom after a peace treaty finally freed Scotland from England's threat.

Today, the Declaration of Arbroath is one of the most celebrated documents in Scottish history. Some historians even argue it inspired the US Declaration of Independence, although proof of this is lacking. Scholars generally agree, however, that what makes the Declaration of Arbroath so historic is the assertion that the king may rule only with the approval of the Scottish people; specifically, the nobles used the document to boldly insist on their right to remove any ruler who betrayed them. In this sense, the document was a pioneering example of a contract between a country's ruler and its people, in which the ruler was responsible for ensuring the people could live in a free society.

大問3C 長文設問 Q38-Q41

前ページの本文を読み、最も適切なものを1つ選びなさい。

- (38) What happened following the death of King Alexander III of Scotland?
- 1 Scotland was able to trick King Edward I into choosing John Balliol even though it was not in Edward's interest to do so.
 - 2 King Edward I began to question the loyalty of the Scottish nobles who had not supported John Balliol's attempt to become king.
 - 3 King Edward I attempted to use the situation to his advantage in order to increase his power over Scotland.
 - 4 Scotland felt so threatened by France's military power that diplomatic relations between the countries worsened.
- (39) What problem did Robert the Bruce face after he became king of Scotland?
- 1 Although he was a great military leader, his lack of political skills led him to negotiate a poor agreement with England.
 - 2 The disagreements he had with his rivals about religion caused many Scottish people to stop supporting him.
 - 3 The religious differences between Scotland and England made it likely that Scotland would be attacked again.
 - 4 Because of the things he had done to gain power, Scotland could not get the support it needed to be safe from England.
- (40) In the year the Declaration of Arbroath was written,
- 1 it became clear that the Pope considered it a priority to recognize Scotland's independence as a nation.
 - 2 the Pope attempted to encourage peace between England and Scotland despite not acknowledging either Robert or his country.
 - 3 the promise of peace between England and Scotland was endangered by Scotland's attempt to get help from the Pope.
 - 4 Scotland was able to achieve enough international recognition to get the Pope to admit that Robert was the country's true king.
- (41) What is one common interpretation of the Declaration of Arbroath?
- 1 It demonstrates that Robert was actually a much better leader than people had originally thought him to be.
 - 2 It brought a new way of looking at the duty that a country's ruler had to the people he or she was governing.
 - 3 It reveals that there was much more conflict between Scottish rulers and nobles at the time than scholars once believed.
 - 4 It suggested that a beneficial system of government was not possible with a king or queen ruling a country.

正解一覧

すべて解き終えてから確認してください。 大問3は正解番号のみを表示しています。



Q01-Q14		Q15-Q28		Q29-Q41	
Q01	3	Q15	1	Q29	3
daunted		forceful		did not lay eggs	
Q02	1	Q16	3	Q30	2
cramming		legacy		On the other hand	
Q03	1	Q17	3	Q31	1
flared		altitude		few dinosaur eggs have been found	
Q04	1	Q18	2	Q32	1
intervention		modest			
Q05	2	Q19	4	Q33	2
protocols		uniform			
Q06	3	Q20	1	Q34	3
ejected		affection			
Q07	2	Q21	1	Q35	2
offspring		buzz			
Q08	1	Q22	4	Q36	3
demotion		hold up			
Q09	4	Q23	4	Q37	1
durable		jumped at			
Q10	4	Q24	2	Q38	3
disclose		fit in			
Q11	2	Q25	3	Q39	4
arrogance		hand over			
Q12	4	Q26	3	Q40	2
incomprehensible		In contrast			
Q13	1	Q27	4	Q41	2
attentively		subjects' expectations had been wrong			
Q14	1	Q28	2		
forefront		other people did not share this desire			

学習記録

得点 _____ / 41

やり直す問題 _____

メモ _____